

Task 2: Cybersecurity Policy

Cybersecurity Policy

Ubuntu Innovations (Pty) Ltd

1. Purpose

The purpose of this Cybersecurity Policy is to protect Ubuntu Innovations' information systems, networks, devices, and data from unauthorized access, cyber threats, data breaches, and operational disruptions. This policy applies to all employees, contractors, consultants, and third-party users who access company systems.

2. Scope

This policy applies to:

- Desktop computers
- Laptops
- Mobile devices
- Servers
- Network equipment
- Cloud services
- Company applications
- Company-owned and authorized personal devices

3. Password Complexity Requirements

To enhance account security, all users must comply with the following password standards:

Password Rules

- Minimum length: **12 characters**
- Must contain:
 - At least one uppercase letter (A–Z)
 - At least one lowercase letter (a–z)
 - At least one number (0–9)

- At least one special character (!@#\$%^&*)
- Passwords may not contain:
 - Usernames
 - Employee numbers
 - Common dictionary words
 - Personal information such as birthdays

Password Management

- Passwords must be changed every **90 days**.
- Users may not reuse their previous **5 passwords**.
- Password sharing is strictly prohibited.
- Passwords must be stored using approved password management software.

4. Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)

- To reduce the risk of unauthorized access:
- MFA is mandatory for:
 - Email accounts
 - VPN access
 - Cloud applications
 - Administrative accounts
- Acceptable authentication methods include:
 - Authentication applications
 - Hardware security tokens
 - SMS verification (only when other methods are unavailable)
- Administrative accounts must always use MFA without exception.

5. Device Encryption Policy

All company devices must use encryption to protect sensitive business information.

Requirements

- Full-disk encryption must be enabled on:

- Laptops
 - Desktop computers
 - Servers
- USB drives containing company data must be encrypted.
- Lost or stolen devices must be reported within **1 hour** of discovery.
- Remote wipe capabilities must be enabled on company laptops and mobile devices where applicable.

6. Antivirus and Endpoint Protection Standards

All endpoints must have approved security software installed.

Security Requirements

- Real-time protection must remain enabled.
- Daily malware signature updates are required.
- Weekly full-system scans must be scheduled.
- Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) tools should be implemented for advanced threat detection.
- Users may not disable antivirus software.

Monitoring

The IT department will:

- Monitor security alerts.
- Investigate suspicious activity.
- Maintain centralized antivirus reporting.

7. Patch Management Policy

Keeping systems updated is essential for cybersecurity.

Update Requirements

- Critical security patches: within **48 hours** of release.
- High-priority updates: within **7 days**.
- Standard updates: within **30 days**.
- Operating systems, applications, and firmware must be regularly updated.

Testing

Updates must:

1. Be tested on non-production systems.
2. Be approved by IT administrators.
3. Be deployed according to a maintenance schedule.

8. Access Control Policy

Access to systems shall follow the **Principle of Least Privilege**.

Rules

- Users receive access only to resources required for their role.
- Departmental folders are restricted based on assigned security groups.
- Administrative privileges are granted only to authorized IT personnel.
- User accounts must be disabled immediately upon employee termination.

9. Email and Internet Security

Employees must:

Email Usage

- Verify sender identities before opening attachments.
- Report suspicious emails immediately.
- Never click unknown or suspicious links.

Internet Usage

- Access only business-related websites during work hours.
- Avoid downloading unauthorized software.
- Use company-approved browsers and security settings.

10. Acceptable Use Policy

Company IT resources are provided for legitimate business purposes.

Employees Must

- Use systems responsibly.
- Protect confidential company information.
- Follow all security procedures.

Employees Must Not

- Install unauthorized software.
- Share passwords.
- Access illegal or offensive content.
- Circumvent security controls.
- Use company systems for unauthorized commercial activities.

Violation of this policy may result in disciplinary action.

11. Data Protection and Backup

To safeguard company information:

- Sensitive data must be stored only on approved systems.
- Shared drives must be backed up according to company backup procedures.
- Employees must not store confidential information on personal devices without authorization.
- Data transfers must use secure encrypted channels.

12. Incident Reporting

Employees must immediately report:

- Suspected malware infections
- Lost or stolen devices
- Unauthorized access attempts
- Phishing emails
- Data breaches

Reports must be submitted to the IT Support Team within **30 minutes** of discovery.

13. Security Awareness Training

All employees shall:

- Complete cybersecurity awareness training upon employment.
- Participate in annual refresher training.
- Complete phishing simulation exercises.
- Stay informed about emerging cyber threats.

14. Compliance and Enforcement

Failure to comply with this policy may result in:

- Revocation of system access
- Formal disciplinary action
- Legal action where applicable

The IT Department is responsible for monitoring compliance and conducting periodic security audits.

15. Policy Approval

Organization: Ubuntu Innovations (Pty) Ltd

Policy Owner: IT Support Department

Version: 1.0

Effective Date: June 2026

Review Frequency: Annually

Conclusion

This Cybersecurity Policy establishes a secure framework for protecting Ubuntu Innovations' information assets through strong authentication, encryption, endpoint protection, patch management, user accountability, and security awareness. By adhering to this policy, the company can significantly reduce cybersecurity risks and maintain business continuity.

This is written in a professional format and is ready to paste directly into your Week 3 report under **Deliverable 11: Cybersecurity Policy**.